



A composed leader is not the one who simply waits for the storm to pass, but the one who acts with calm urgency, balancing realism with optimism. That steadiness of the leader becomes the organisation's stabiliser"

PAUL DUPUIS

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HOW LEADERS CAN BUILD GEOPOLITICAL AWARENESS



in India and globally, agree that leadership in the age of uncertainty calls for capabilities that balance agility with foresight.

While there is no single defining skill, 31% of CEOs in India (compared to 26% globally) identify greater agility and faster decision-making under pressure as among the most critical leadership attributes. CEOs in India also place higher importance on regulatory understanding, ranking it second versus fourth globally, finds the KPMG 2025 India CEO Outlook. Conversely, CEOs globally (24%) attach greater importance to transparency in communication than their Indian counterparts (18%), reflecting the growing need for open

dialogue and trust-building across diverse and distributed teams.

Nagporewalla notes that as AI and tech transformation accelerate, leaders are becoming more agile, digitally fluent, and responsive to regulatory shifts. "Many are prioritising AI adoption, rethinking workforce strategies, and strengthening skill development, moves that position organisations not just to withstand change, but to lead through it."

He adds that this future-focused mindset is also evident in the way Indian CEOs are approaching complexity, by embracing emerging technologies, prioritising cybersecurity, advancing ESG goals, and fostering continuous

learning. "These efforts are helping organisations remain competitive and resilient."

BUILDING AWARENESS

Paul Dupuis, a seasoned business leader and author with experience across Asia, believes geopolitical awareness isn't a PowerPoint exercise, it's a mindset. "Geopolitical intelligence doesn't live in a slide deck," he says. "It's rooted in culture and conversations."

As founder and CEO of Take-5 Global KK, a leadership and advisory consultancy operating in Japan and India and formerly CEO of Randstad Japan and Randstad India, Dupuis has watched how geopolitics can tilt markets overnight.